

Eatwell Guide

Check the label on packaged foods

Each serving (150g) contains

Energy	Fat	Saturated	Sugars	Salt
1048kJ 250kcal	3.0g	1.3g	34g	0.9g
	Low	Low	High	Med
13%	4%	7%	38%	15%

of an adult's reference intake
Typical values (as sold) per 100g: 697kJ/ 167kcal

Choose foods lower
in fat, salt and sugars

Use the Eatwell Guide to help you get a balance of healthier and more sustainable food. It shows how much of what you eat overall should come from each food group.



Water, lower fat milk, sugar-free drinks including tea and coffee all count.

Limit fruit juice and/or smoothies to a total of 150ml a day.



Source: Public Health England in association with the Welsh Government, Food Standards Scotland and the Food Standards Agency in Northern Ireland

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the different types of foods and drinks you should consume – and in what proportions – every day or over a week.

There are more than 40 different kinds of nutrients in food and they can generally be classified into the following 7 major groups:

Carbohydrates

Proteins

Fats

Vitamins

Minerals

Dietary fibre

Water

You should try to choose a variety of foods from each group to help you get the nutrients you need to stay healthy.

Although each nutrient performs different functions in our body, they all work together and contribute to our good health.

These recommendations apply to most people regardless of their:

- weight
- dietary restrictions or preferences
- ethnic origin

If you've special dietary or medical needs, ask a registered dietitian or nutritionist about the best way to adapt this guide to your needs.

- **balance is a crucial element of success to any workout goal, whether looking to build muscle, lose fat, or improve athletic performance.** It is a crucial aspect of every part of our lives, between balancing free time to maximize potential extra visits to the gym to balancing our caloric intake. It all plays a big role in the results we will see.

A well-balanced diet provides important vitamins, minerals, and nutrients to keep the body and mind strong and healthy. Eating well can also help ward off numerous diseases and health complications, as well as help maintain a healthy body weight, provide energy, allow better sleep, and improve brain function. **A diet with balance provides the body with the proper proportions of carbohydrates, fats, proteins, vitamins, minerals, and liquids. It is important to not eliminate any essential macronutrient, such as fats or carbohydrates, but be conscious of portion control.**

- **1. Control Body Weight**

Eating a healthy variety of nutrient-dense foods leaves less room for those calorie-dense foods that typically lead to weight gain. These would be such foods as, processed foods and fatty or sugary snacks that provide little nutritional value. **The body has little use for these foods and will tend to store rather than use them for energy.** Eating carbohydrates like whole grains, oats, vegetables, fruits, legumes, and quinoa that have a low glycemic index (*ranking of carbohydrates on a scale from 0 to 100 based on how much they raise blood sugar levels after consuming*) will allow the body to stay fuller over a longer period of time. These complex carbohydrates break down and release into the blood stream over an extended period of time preventing triggers in the brain to crave simple sugary snacks. Along with lean proteins (chicken, most seafood, eggs, lean cuts of pork, etc.), the metabolism can stay elevated longer limiting the feeling of hunger after a short time frame.

- **2. Fight Off Disease**

- **When eating a balanced diet, essential nutrients will produce and help maintain key germ-fighting cells in the immune system, and greatly improve vascular function. The immune system relies heavily on blood flow, so better vascular function will help provide disease fighting cells to areas of need quickly.**

Deficiencies in certain nutrients can impair immune system function, such as vitamin A, B-vitamins, vitamin C, vitamin E, Zinc, and Iron. A diet filled with fruits and vegetables also increases the production of infection-fighting white blood cells and materials that help prevent bacteria and infections from attaching themselves to cells in the body.

- Some of the **most important aspects of a balanced diet is the reduction in risk of cardiovascular disease. Vitamin C raises levels of good cholesterol (HDL) and lowers blood pressure**, two very important potential stresses to the cardiovascular system that need to be monitored. **Vitamin C also helps interfere with fat being converted to plaque in the arteries. Essential fatty acids also protect the body against damage from over-reactions to infection.** A balanced diet will limit the amount of excess body fat that can develop, which puts extra stress on the cardiovascular system eventually causing serious problems.

- **3. Have More Energy**

The food we eat has a tremendous impact on the energy we have throughout the day. **Nutrient-dense foods will digest and therefore be released into the system over a longer period of time.** On the other hand, easily digestible food (sugary/simple carbohydrates) will digest much quicker, causing the body to feel hungry again in a much shorter time frame. This can cause spikes in the release of energy into the bloodstream, immediately followed by lows. Ideally, the goal is to **maintain energy levels through the day without these extreme highs and lows.** Eating well keeps our energy on a relatively level base from morning until night. Proteins can help provide satiety much more effectively than processed foods or simple carbohydrates. **Every 3-4 hours consuming a source of protein can be a very important rule to live by to prevent unnecessary snacking. Also, make sure to increase healthy fats, which the body will use for energy more compared to unhealthy saturated and trans-saturated fats.** These unhealthy fats can make you feel sluggish as the body fights to break it down and absorb harmful byproducts. **Food that is also iron-rich, like dark leafy greens, can also help provide a boost in energy because iron helps deliver oxygen to working muscles and the brain, which is what they run on.**

- **4. Sleep Better**

- **There are few things our bodies need more than sleep. It allows our muscles to recover and replenish from the day's activities and workouts.** Sleep will rejuvenate the brain and its ability to function at a high level for the next day. Without it we feel sluggish, energy levels remain low, focus and concentration levels are affected, and cravings for less beneficial food are triggered. Poor eating habits often cause stomach and digestive issues due to the toxins that may be released into the blood system. **Raised acidity can also put a strain on the digestive system, making it very difficult to get a good night's sleep.** It is important to not overeat at night time, which many people are guilty of due to poor eating habits during the day. Making sure meals are spaced out effectively becomes an important rule once again. **We do not want our bodies starving by the end of the day and have to make up for a lack of nutrients with a large dinner.** It makes it extremely difficult for the body to prepare for sleep when it is working hard to digest a large number of calories. Plan the next day out, so you don't run into a situation that leads to a sleepless night.

- **5. More Brain Power**

- What could possibly be more important than our brains? We have an opportunity to keep it healthy and functioning at a high level based on our eating habits. **Omega 3 fatty acids provide a number of important benefits, such as improved memory and the ability to learn. They also help fight against debilitating mental disorders, for example, depression, dementia, and schizophrenia.** Foods such as salmon, walnuts, avocado, and kiwi contain these important fatty acids. Omega3s can provide long term benefits to support synaptic plasticity which is how our memory and learning are developed and possibly improved. So make sure they become an essential part of your diet for a clear and highly functioning brain.

A food exchange list consists of similar foods grouped together so that specified amounts of each food listed in that group have approximately the same energy, carbohydrate, protein and fat content. So any one food in a particular exchange list can be exchanged for another in the same list. This facilitates a wider choice in selecting foods within every exchange, while controlling the total calorie, protein and fat in the daily diet. Nine food exchange lists have been prescribed

- **Food Exchange List (FEL)** is a user friendly tool which was developed to help individuals to aid healthy eating habits and **follow a specific diet plan**. This may be a helpful supplementary strategy when helping patients prevent or manage non-communicable diseases that are affected by diet especially those with diabetes.
- **The Exchange Lists for Meal Planning** is a helpful meal-building tool. You have the flexibility to mix and match your carbohydrate food choices, while staying within your carbohydrate budget for each meal.
- It provides a framework to foods with similar carbohydrate, protein, fat, and calorie contents.
- It emphasizes important management concepts, such as carbohydrate amounts, fat modification, calorie control, and awareness of high-sodium foods.
- By making food choices from each of the different food exchange lists, a variety of healthful food choices can be assured

- For example, if your goal is 45 grams of carbohydrate per meal, = 3 exchanges or 3 types of carbohydrates at each meal.
- **Let's say you wanted to have some rice at lunch.**
- **1/3 cup of cooked rice is One exchange of rice = 15 grams carb**
- If your goal is 45 grams of carbohydrate at a meal, then you can eat 1 cup of rice ($1/3 \times 3$) = 45 grams of carbohydrate.

In the mood for a different meal?

- Using the same goal of 45 gram carbohydrate per meal, you could also choose:
- 1 slice of bread with peanut butter
- 1 (8 ounce) cup of nonfat milk
- 1 small apple
- Each food item listed above equals 1 carbohydrate exchange – so that's a total of 3 exchanges, or 45 grams of carbohydrate.

Dietary reference intakes (DRIs) are a set of scientifically developed reference values for nutrients.

- DRI values provide the scientific basis for nutrition professionals, governments, and non-governmental organizations to carry out activities such as:
- **Developing nutrition labels**
- **Developing dietary guidelines and food guides**
- **Ensuring foods and supplements contain safe levels of nutrients**
- **Creating patient and consumer counseling and educational programs**
- **Assessing nutrient intakes and monitoring the nutritional health of the population**

The Dietary Reference Intakes (DRIs) may be used for many purposes, most of which fall into two broad categories:

assessing existing nutrient intakes and planning for future nutrient intakes. Each category may be further subdivided into uses for individual diets and uses for diets of groups

- **The professionals may use the DRI recommendations to create diets for people in different public institutions, such as hospitals, schools, or prisons. They're also helpful for companies coming up with new foods or dietary supplements.**

DIETARY GUIDELINES

Right nutritional behavior and dietary choices are needed to achieve dietary goals. The following 15 dietary guidelines provide a broad framework for appropriate action:

1. Eat variety of foods to ensure a balanced diet.
2. Ensure provision of extra food and healthcare to pregnant and lactating women.
3. Promote exclusive breastfeeding for six months and encourage breastfeeding till two years or as long as one can.
4. Feed home based semi solid foods to the infant after six months.
5. Ensure adequate and appropriate diets for children and adolescents, both in health and sickness.
6. Eat plenty of vegetables and fruits.
7. Ensure moderate use of edible oils and animal foods and very less use of ghee/ butter/ vanaspati.
8. Avoid overeating to prevent overweight and obesity.
9. Exercise regularly and be physically active to maintain ideal body weight.
10. Restrict salt intake to minimum.
11. Ensure the use of safe and clean foods.

12. Adopt right pre-cooking processes and appropriate cooking methods.
13. Drink plenty of water and take beverages in moderation.
14. Minimize the use of processed foods rich in salt, sugar and fats.
15. Include micronutrient-rich foods in the diets of elderly people to enable them to be fit and active.

Meal planning is making a plan of meals with adequate nutrition for every member of the family within the available resources. The term 'available resources' means whatever the family has in terms of time, energy and money.

IMPORTANCE OF MEAL PLANNING

Meal planning is important for meeting the nutritional requirements of the family members.

It helps us to decide what to eat each day and in each meal.

We can call it our 'daily food guide'.

Meal planning helps us to: (a) fulfill the nutritional requirements of the family members (b) make the food economical (c) cater to the food preferences of individual members (d) save energy, time and money (e) use left over food

FACTORS AFFECTING MEAL PLANNING

1. Nutritional Adequacy: This is the most important factor, which means that the nutritional requirements of all the family members are fulfilled. For example, you know a growing child needs more protein, a pregnant or lactating woman needs calcium, etc. While planning meals you will include food items from various food groups, that is, energy giving foods, body building foods and protective and regulating foods.

2. Age: People normally eat according to their age. You must have observed in your family that the diet of various members of different age groups differs in quantity. A new born baby drinks only milk, a small child's meal is also of very small quantity, an adolescent eats still more in amount and variety of foods. Similarly, you must have seen your grandfather eating less food and also that they prefer soft and easy to digest foods

3. Sex: Sex is another factor which determines the dietary intake. Dietary requirement of adolescent and adult males are more than their female counterparts.

4. Physical Activity: The kind of work a person does affects the kind and amount of food they need to take. A laborer not only eats more quantity but needs more energy because he is engaged in hard work. His body uses up more energy while performing hard work. So, if you have to plan for such a person you will include more energy giving foods in the diet.

5. Economic Considerations: Money available to the family to be spent on food is another major factor. Foods like milk, cheese, meat, fruits, nuts etc. are expensive. However, alternative sources like toned milk, seasonal fruits and vegetables are less costly and at the same time nutritious. You can therefore plan a balanced diet to suit every budget.

6. Time, energy and skill considerations: While planning the meals, you should consider the resources like time, energy and skill available to the family. Meals can be elaborate with different dishes but you can simplify them by cooking a simple but nutritious dish.

7. Seasonal availability: Some foods are available in summers while some in winters. The off season foods are expensive and less nutritious, while those in season are fresh, nutritious, tasty and cheap. Hence, while planning seasonal foods should be used.

8. Religion, region, cultural patterns, traditions and customs: Regional factors influence meal planning. For example, if you are a North Indian, you will consume more of wheat, while those near the coastal region, will consume more of coconut, fish, etc.

9. Variety in colour and texture: variety in terms of colour, texture, flavour and method of preparation is important. These factors help you to make meals more appealing, attractive and hence more acceptable.

10. Satiety Value: While planning meals, take care that you select foods which provide satiety value.

Meals which produce inadequate satiety, will lead to onset of hunger pangs, which in turn will affect the working capacity and efficiency of a person. (Satiety : Feeling of fullness after eating)

Food behavior

- Psychological factors

➤ Stress

Psychological stress is a common feature of modern life and can modify behaviours that affect health, such as physical activity, smoking or food choice. The effect of stress on food intake depends on the individual, the stressor and the circumstances. In general, some people eat more and some eat less than normal when experiencing stress. The proposed mechanisms for stress induced changes in eating and food choice are motivational differences (reduced concern about weight control), physiological (reduced appetite caused by the processes associated with stress) and practical changes in eating opportunities, food availability and meal preparation.

Studies also suggest that if work stress is prolonged or frequent, then adverse dietary changes could result, increasing the possibility of weight gain and consequently cardiovascular risk.

➤ Mood

Healing power of food- food is considered a tool to modify temperament and mood. It appears that the influence of food on mood is related in part to attitudes towards particular foods. The ambivalent relationship with food – wanting to enjoy it but conscious of weight gain is a struggle experienced by many. Attempts to restrict intake of certain foods can increase the desire for these particular foods, leading to what are described as food cravings.

Women more commonly report food cravings than do men. Depressed mood appears to influence the severity of these cravings. Reports of food cravings are also more common in the premenstrual phase, a time when total food intake increases and a parallel change in basal metabolic rate occurs. Thus, mood and stress can influence food choice behavior and possibly short and long term responses to dietary intervention.